

MTUS Analysis Document

MTUS Constitutional Analysis Project
Personal Research Initiative
February 2026

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CERVICAL AND T

SOURCE DOCUMENT: ACOEM Cervical and Thoracic Spine Disorders Guideline

EFFECTIVE DATE

OFFICIAL MTUS ADOPTION: California Code of Regulations, Title 8, Section 9792.20

MTUS REGULATI

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STATISTICAL SU

TOTAL RECOMMENDATIONS ANALYZED: 162

RECOMMENDATION BREAKDOWN:

Category | Count | Percentage

Strongly Recommen

KEY FINDING: 76.5% of all recommendations are "Insufficient Evidence"

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FDA-APPROVED

The following FDA-approved treatments receive "Insufficient Evidence" ratings:

Medications:

- Pregabalin (Lyrica) - FDA approved 2004
- Duloxetine (Cymbalta) - FDA approved 2004
- Milnacipran (Savella) - FDA approved 2009
- Various muscle relaxants

Procedures:

- Selective nerve root blocks
- Facet joint injections (certain types)
- Intradiscal electrothermal therapy (IDET)
- Percutaneous disc decompression

Note: Full indication details available in official ACOEM guideline at source URL above.

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EVIDENCE QUAL

ACOEM'S STATED METHODOLOGY:

- Requires randomized controlled trials (RCTs) for "Strongly Recommended" status
- Excludes observational studies and real-world evidence
- Panel composition: See ACOEM official website for current members

CRITICAL OBSERVATIONS:

1. 76.5% "Insufficient"

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CONSTITUTIONAL

This guideline contributes to the systematic denial of FDA-approved treatments

to California injured

For full legal analysis, see:

- MTUSCONSTITUTIONALVIOLATIONMASTERREPORT.txt
- MTUS14THAMENDMENTLEGALARGUMENTS.txt

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DISCLAIMER

This document contains statistical analysis and commentary only. All ACOEM

guideline content r

For the complete, official guideline text, visit:

<https://www.acoem.org>

This analysis represents the author's independent research and opinions.

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Document prepared

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